SpeedUP

English Course

SpeakUp English Course

Advanced Grammar in Context

Gramática Avançada Integrada à Comunicação Fluente

Sample excerpts for analysis

"Never have I witnessed such dedication from a team." — Sports commentator

"It was the lack of communication that ultimately caused the project to fail." — Business article

"Had he arrived ten minutes earlier, the outcome would have been very different." — Crime novel

Language for Talking About Language

Usage Tip

Language for Talking About Language

Usage Tip:
• Register refers to the level of formality in language — academic, professional, casual, or literary. • Nuance and implication are key words for B2+ discussions about meaning.

Syntax (noun) Sintaxe

The syntax of this sentence is unusual but completely correct.

Nuance

Nuance / Sutileza

There is an important nuance between "tired" and "exhausted."

Register

Registro (formal/informal)

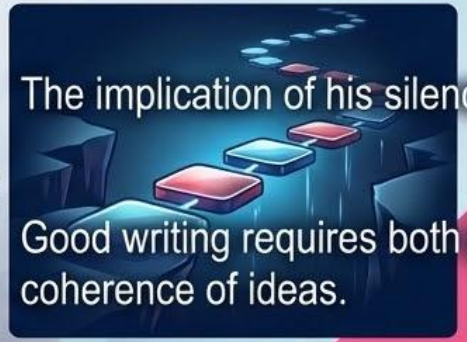
Formal writing requires a different register than casual conversation.

Register (noun) Registro (formal/informal)

Implication (noun) Implicação / Subtexto

Coherence (noun) Coerência

The implication of his silence was that he disagreed.



FRUIT

Expanding Your Vocabulary: Word Families & Collocations

Precise (adj.)

Preciso / Exato

Word Family:
Precisely (adv.)
Precision (noun)
Imprecise (antonym)

Choose a precise word rather than a vague one to avoid ambiguity.

Ambiguous (adj.)

Ambíguo

Word Family:
Ambiguously (adv.)
Ambiguity (noun)
Unambiguous (antonym)

The instruction was so ambiguous that nobody knew what to do.

Convey (verb)

Transmitir / Expressar

Word Family:
Conveyance (noun)
(often for tone/emotion)

His tone of voice conveyed more than his actual words did.

Elaborate (verb)

Elaborar / Detalhar

Word Family:
Elaboration (noun)

Could you elaborate on that point? I'd like to understand better.

FRUIT

Level: **FRUIT** (B2 - Intermediate to Advanced)

Mixing Time Frames in Conditionals

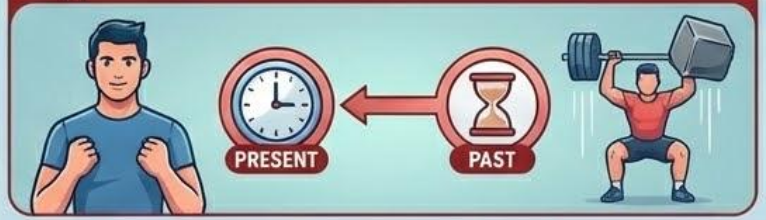
What are Mixed Conditionals?

- Unlike standard conditionals (all in the same time), **mixed** conditionals combine different time frames.
- They show how a past situation affects the present, or how a present situation would have changed the past.

Type A: Past Condition → Present Result

Meaning: "If something had happened in the past, things would be different now."

Type B: Present Condition → Past Result



Meaning: "If something were different now, something else would have happened in the past."

FRUIT

Level: **FRUIT** (B2 - Intermediate to Advanced)

Inversion for Emphasis

Formal Emphasis Through Inverted Word Order

What is Inversion?

Inversion places a negative or restrictive adverb at the beginning of the sentence, followed by auxiliary + subject (like a question). This creates strong emphasis and is common in formal writing and speeches.

Adverb + Aux + Subject + Verb

Never

Never + aux + subject + verb

Never have I seen such dedication.

Not only

Not only + aux + subject + verb

Not only did she pass — she got top marks!

Rarely

Rarely + aux + subject + verb

Rarely does he make such a mistake.

Seldom

Seldom + aux + subject + verb

Seldom have we faced a challenge like this.

Hardly... when

Hardly + aux + subject + verb + when

Hardly had I sat down when the phone rang.

No sooner... than

No sooner + aux + subject + verb + than

No sooner had she left than it started raining.

FRUIT

Level: FRUIT (B2 - Intermediate to Advanced)

Isolating and Highlighting Information

Cleft Sentences for Emphasis

Emphasis on need/want/problem

I need more time. → **What I need is more time.**

She wants recognition. → **What she wants is recognition.**

Bothers me most is the noise. → **What bothers me most is the noise.**

Emphasis on subject/time

John broke the window. → **It was John who broke the window.** *(not someone else)*

The noise woke me up. → **It was the noise that woke me up.** *(not something else)*

She called me yesterday. → **It was yesterday that she called me.** *(not another time)*

FRUIT

Level: FRUIT (B2 - Intermediate to Advanced)